ENGLISH DRILL BOOK · DEMO

Everyday Grammar

A Demo Course

Four short units of English grammar

Level A1

This short course shows how English Drill Book works. Each unit has a page that explains one point of grammar and a page of exercises. The answers are at the back of the book.

Read the explanation first, then do the exercises. Write your answers in the app or in a notebook, and check them with the key. The companion book, Everyday Grammar: Demo Drills, has more practice on the same four topics.

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How to use this book

Each unit starts with a page that explains the grammar: a short rule, examples and a note on a common mistake. The exercises follow on the next page. Write a whole sentence where there is a line to write on. Check your answers in the key at the back of the book.

Contents

Unit 1 To be: am, is, are 3

Unit 2 Present simple 5

Unit 3 A and an 7

Unit 4 There is and there are 10

Answer key 12

Unit 1 To be: am, is, are

We use the verb be to say who people are, where they are and what they are like. Be has three forms in the present: am, is and are.

Positive

I	**am**	*I'm cold.*
he, she, it	**is**	*She's at work.*
we, you, they	**are**	*They're my neighbours.*

To make a negative, put not after am, is or are. In speech we usually use the short forms isn't and aren't. There is no short form of am not: say I'm not.

- *I'm not late, the bus is early.*
- *The shop isn't open on Mondays.*
- *Our cats aren't in the house.*

In a question the verb comes before the person or thing. A question word, such as where or how, comes first of all.

- *Are you tired?*
- *Is this your scarf?*
- *Where is the station?*

Short answers

Answer a yes or no question with the person and the verb: Yes, I am. No, she isn't. In a positive short answer, do not use the short form: Yes, we are, not Yes, we're.

Exercises for Unit 1

1.1 Complete the sentences with am, is or are.

1. My name ___ Marta.
2. I ___ from a small town by the sea.
3. Omar and Priya ___ in the garden.
4. The soup ___ very hot.
5. You ___ early today!
6. It ___ cold in this room.
7. We ___ ready for the test.
8. I ___ hungry. Is there any bread?

1.2 Choose the correct word.

1. The keys ___ on the table. **[is / are]**
2. My bike ___ blue and white. **[is / are]**
3. ___ you a teacher? **[Am / Is / Are]**
4. Sven ___ not at work today. **[is / are]**
5. These shoes ___ new. **[is / are]**
6. I ___ in the kitchen. **[am / is]**

1.3 Make the sentences negative.

1. I am tired.

2. The bus is late.

3. We are at home.

4. My phone is in my bag.

5. Kofi and Nell are friends.

Unit 2 Present simple

We use the present simple for things that are true in general and for things we do again and again: habits, routines and timetables.

Positive

I, you, we, they	**work**	*I work in a shop.*
he, she, it	**works**	*She works in a bank.*

After he, she and it, add -s to the verb. Verbs that end in -ch, -sh, -s, -x or -o add -es: watch, watches; go, goes. A consonant and y becomes -ies: study, studies. Have becomes has.

Negatives and questions use do or does and the plain verb, with no -s.

- *I don't eat meat. Bruno doesn't drive.*
- *Do you like tea? Does she live here?*
- *Where do your parents work?*

Careful

Does already shows that the person is he, she or it, so the verb after it stays plain: Does he work? not Does he works?

Exercises for Unit 2

2.1 Write the verb in brackets in the present simple.

1. My aunt ___ in a small town. (live)
2. We ___ to work by bus. (go)
3. Ivo ___ his teeth after breakfast. (brush)
4. The baby ___ a lot at night. (cry)
5. They ___ football on Sundays. (play)
6. My dog ___ the postman. (not like)
7. Dasha ___ two cats and a parrot. (have)

2.2 Choose do or does.

1. ___ you speak French? **[Do / Does]**
2. Where ___ your brother work? **[do / does]**
3. I ___ not eat fish. **[do / does]**
4. ___ the train stop at this station? **[Do / Does]**
5. What time ___ your lessons start? **[do / does]**
6. Marta ___ not watch TV. **[do / does]**

2.3 Read about Omar. Write the text again with the verbs in the present simple.

Omar (live) in a flat near the river. He (get) up at seven and (have) a quick breakfast. Then he (walk) to the library, where he (look) after old maps. In the evening he (cook) dinner and (call) his sister.

Unit 3 A and an

Use a or an before a singular noun when you talk about one thing, or when you say what something or somebody is.

Which one?

a	**before a consonant sound**	*a cup, a lemon, a house*
an	**before a vowel sound**	*an egg, an onion, an idea*

The sound decides, not the letter. Hour starts with a vowel sound, because the h is silent, so we say an hour. Uniform and university start with a y sound, so we say a uniform.

Use a or an when you say what job somebody does.

- *She is a pilot.*
- *My cousin is an electrician.*
- *Is he a student?*

Careful

Do not use a or an with a plural noun: apples, not an apples. And do not leave it out before a job: I am a nurse, not I am nurse.

Exercises for Unit 3

3.1 Choose a or an.

1 She eats ___ apple every day. **[a / an]**
2 We have ___ new teacher. **[a / an]**
3 Take ___ umbrella. It might rain. **[a / an]**
4 My dad is ___ engineer. **[a / an]**
5 They live in ___ old house. **[a / an]**
6 Can I have ___ glass of water? **[a / an]**
7 He waited for ___ hour. **[a / an]**
8 This is ___ useful map. **[a / an]**

3.2 Write a or an before each word.

1 ___ egg
2 ___ banana
3 ___ island
4 ___ uniform
5 ___ orange
6 ___ desk
7 ___ ice cream
8 ___ holiday

3.3 What do these people do? Write a sentence about each person with a or an.

1 Priya / doctor. She works at the hospital in the centre of town.

2 Sven / actor. He is in a play at the theatre this month.

3 my uncle / farmer. He has sheep, hens and a very old tractor.

4 Nell / architect. She draws plans for new schools and libraries.

5 Bruno / taxi driver. He knows every street in the city.

6 my cousin / artist. She paints large pictures of the sea.

7 Kofi / engineer. He builds bridges over rivers and roads.

Exercise 3.3 continues on the next page.

8 Dasha / police officer. She works at night in the old part of town.

9 Ivo / waiter. He brings coffee and cake to the people at the tables.

10 my neighbour / English teacher. Her students are adults.

Unit 4 There is and there are

Use there is and there are to say that something exists, or to say where it is. The noun after them decides which one you use.

Positive

there is	**+ a singular noun**	*There is a bank in our street.*
there are	**+ a plural noun**	*There are two parks near the school.*

The short form of there is is there's. For negatives use isn't and aren't. In questions, is or are comes first.

- *There isn't a lift in this building.*
- *Are there any eggs in the fridge?*
- *Yes, there are. No, there aren't.*

Some and any

With a plural noun, use some in positive sentences and any in negatives and questions: There are some cups. There aren't any spoons. Are there any forks?

Exercises for Unit 4

4.1 Complete the sentences with there is or there are.

1 ___ a big tree in our garden.
2 ___ three bedrooms in the flat.
3 ___ some milk in the fridge.
4 ___ two cafes in the village.
5 ___ a problem with my phone.
6 ___ lots of people at the station.

4.2 Choose the correct beginning.

1 ___ a bank near here? **[Is there / Are there]**
2 ___ any shops in your street? **[Is there / Are there]**
3 ___ a cat on the sofa. **[There is / There are]**
4 ___ any eggs in the box? **[Is there / Are there]**
5 ___ many trees in the park. **[There is / There are]**

4.3 Write four sentences about your room. Use there is and there are.

Ideas: a bed, a window, a desk, some books, a lamp, some pictures, a plant.

Answer key

Unit 1 To be: am, is, are

1.1 **1** is **2** am **3** are **4** is **5** are **6** is **7** are **8** am

1.2 **1** are **2** is **3** Are **4** is **5** are **6** am

1.3 **1** I am not tired **2** The bus is not late **3** We are not at home **4** My phone is not in my bag **5** Kofi and Nell are not friends

Unit 2 Present simple

2.1 **1** lives **2** go **3** brushes **4** cries **5** play **6** doesn't like **7** has

2.2 **1** Do **2** does **3** do **4** Does **5** do **6** does

2.3 Omar lives in a flat near the river. He gets up at seven and has a quick breakfast. Then he walks to the library, where he looks after old maps. In the evening he cooks dinner and calls his sister.

Unit 3 A and an

3.1 **1** an **2** a **3** an **4** an **5** an **6** a **7** an **8** a

3.2 **1** an (egg) **2** a (banana) **3** an (island) **4** a (uniform) **5** an (orange) **6** a (desk) **7** an (ice cream) **8** a (holiday)

3.3 **1** Priya is a doctor; She is a doctor **2** Sven is an actor; He is an actor **3** My uncle is a farmer; He is a farmer **4** Nell is an architect; She is an architect **5** Bruno is a taxi driver; He is a taxi driver **6** My cousin is an artist; She is an artist **7** Kofi is an engineer; He is an engineer **8** Dasha is a police officer; She is a police officer **9** Ivo is a waiter; He is a waiter **10** My neighbour is an English teacher; She is an English teacher

Unit 4 There is and there are

4.1 **1** There is **2** There are **3** There is **4** There are **5** There is **6** There are

4.2 **1** Is there **2** Are there **3** There is **4** Are there **5** There are

4.3 *Answers will vary. Example:* There is a bed next to the window. There are some books on the desk. There isn't a television. There are two pictures on the wall.